

volatile. The IPO of insurance behemoth LIC—the biggest one this year—has proven to be a wealth destroyer for investors as the stock has slipped around 33 per cent from its issue price. The silver lining is that of the 29 new listings in 2022, only seven have slipped below their issue price. Among the outperformers are names such as Adani Wilmar which is up over 175 per cent from its issue price, followed by Venus Pipes and Veranda Learning which are up over 115 per cent and 100 per cent, respectively, from their issue price.

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GOING FORWARD, 2023 looks more promising as markets regulator, the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi), has given its approval to at least 65 companies to raise about ₹1 lakh crore through the primary market in the coming 12 months. Data available with Prime Database shows that companies including Fabindia, Biba Fashion, VLCC Health Care, Sula Vineyards, TVS Supply Chain Solutions, Macleods Pharmaceuticals, Bharat FIH, Emcure Pharmaceuticals, and Go Airlines have secured Sebi's clearance for public offers so far. This apart, 40 more companies—including names such as Oravel Stays (OYO), Snapdeal, Joyalukkas India, Signature Global, Go Digit General Insurance and Yatra Online—have filed offer documents. These companies may be looking to raise another ₹60,000 crore via their public issues, says Pranav Haldea, Managing Director of Prime Database Group.

In the secondary market, in terms of individual performers, as many as 46 companies of the BSE 500 index have jumped over 50 per cent YTD (as of November 18) with Adani Power emerging as the top gainer with returns of 237 per cent. As a whole, the Adani Group has been the biggest wealth creator of 2022 for investors with Adani En-



“The New Year [2023] will reward disciplined investors, who can take the market volatility in their stride”

NILESH SHAH
MANAGING DIRECTOR,
KOTAK MAHINDRA AMC



“India's outperformance vis-à-vis the world will continue in 2023. The risk is in sitting out rather than staying invested. But unlike 2021 this is not a market where everything will go up”

DEVINA MEHRA
CHAIRPERSON, MD & FOUNDER,
FIRST GLOBAL



“Western investors have \$3.5 trillion invested in China... of that, even if half a trillion dollars comes to India, that will virtually double the FII investments in the country. I'm hopeful that this is going to happen over the next three years”

SAURABH MUKHERJEA
FOUNDER & CIO, MARCELLUS
INVESTMENT MANAGERS

terprises surging over 135 per cent and Adani Total Gas up 112 per cent. In fact, all seven listed firms from the group have given double-digit returns so far this year. The other big movers this year have been Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders, Bharat Dynamics, Deepak Fertilisers, Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL) and Lemon Tree Hotels, all of which have more than doubled investors' wealth this year, giving over 100-194 per cent returns.

As for upcoming IPOs, Rahul Arora, CEO of Nirmal Bang Institutional Equities, says: “The kind of IPOs that are coming now are very different from what got launched 15-18 months ago. From new-generation fintech and consumer tech companies last year, there seems to be a shift towards traditional companies which are making a profit as well.”

Among new-age tech firms that were listed last year, Paytm, Policybazaar, Zomato and Nykaa—all have tumbled between 45-60 per cent YTD. Arora says that for new-age companies, the worst may be behind them. “A lot of these firms that listed at steep valuations have now come down to reasonable prices... so there may be a case to look positively at some of them now,” he says.

Then what should investors do in 2023? Experts believe that while the markets will be heading higher, it won't be easy to make money as there will be the impact of the rate hikes seen across the world. Arora says that 2023 will see a lot of government spending as it is a pre-election year. “The right way to approach the markets would be via a SIP strategy to spread the risk. Also, I'd prefer passive investing over active investing in the New Year, which means placing bets on the index for the next year would be a better route,” he says. **BT**

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